

1960

Programming And Neural Networks

June: Neural Networks

The Perceptron, also known as the MARK 1, built by Frank Rosenblatt at Cornell University, was a computer that could learn by trial an error, which was also the first time artificial neural networks were used in computing. It was built on an IBM 704.

July: Compiler Compilers

The first compiler compiler was written by Tony Brooker at the University of Manchester. Compiler compilers, also known as parser generators, are used to derive the source code of a parser, interpreter or compiler where the input is the grammar of the language. Even if you don't know what the above means, suffice it to say that without compiler compilers, it would be impossible to develop compilers for any language, and consequently impossible to write programs. YACC (Yet Another Compiler Compiler) is a typical example of one.

Communications Standards

The RS-232 communication standard was unveiled. This standard governs how binary data signals are transferred between serial ports in computers. Such standards have undergone numerous revisions over the years.

1961

Time-sharing—The Concept

February: The First Computer Game

Spacewar! was conceived by MIT students Martin Graetz, Stephen Russell, and Wayne Witanen. It was completed in 1962. It is considered the first computer game. It was first run on the PDP-1, a minicomputer. It was a simple two-player game that involved two spaceships trying to destroy each other by “firing” projectiles. The position and angle of the space ships could be altered with consoles. The game was character based.